

## ***CARLOS GUZMAN (#20), NEW YORK METS***

**Level:** AA (Binghamton Rumble Ponies)

**Position(s):** RHP

**Age:** 28

**B/T:** R/R

**Dates Seen:** 6/12/26 and 6/14/26

**Projected Role:** Organizational Depth

**Ceiling:** Up-and-Down MLB Reliever

**Floor:** Backend AA Reliever

|        |       |
|--------|-------|
| Season | 2026  |
| Team   | NYM   |
| Level  | MILB  |
| G      | 20    |
| GS     | 0     |
| IP     | 30.0  |
| K%     | 29.6% |
| BB%    | 10.4% |
| GB%    | 47.9% |
| ERA    | 4.80  |
| FIP    | 4.66  |

### ***Delivery***

His motion starts with a high leg kick, his glove raised in sync, before he drives well off his back leg and pushes his glove out in front of his face to create good hip-shoulder separation. Guzman reaches his arm far behind his back as he rides down the slope of the mound, then uncorks it after planting his front leg. The late arm action adds deception to his slider and changeup, while also providing enough arm-side run on his mid-to-high 90s fastball to beat hitters. There is concern that this will be hard to repeat and could lead to long-term control issues. This was noticeable, as Guzman did have a couple of uncompetitive misses.

### ***Arsenal***

Guzman, at 28 and with many years in the minors, is not going to appear on any top prospect boards, but he still displayed impressive sequencing and overpowering stuff in his two appearances. Guzman pitched 3.1 innings over the two appearances, not allowing a hit while walking 1 and striking out 4. Guzman used his fastball-slider combo to attack hitters early in the count and produce a lot of whiffs to put hitters away with two strikes. Guzman also displayed a CH that fooled hitters, but did not throw it too often. Guzman can reach back and hit mid-to-high 90s with his fastball. In short, Guzman effectively used his FB to set up offspeed pitches, and hitters took bad swings, made weak contact, and whiffed often.

### ***Command***

Guzman continued his success from 6/12 and 6/14 in his next two appearances, but had his command issues pop up to derail him on 6/24 in his third appearance. From 6/7-6/21, Guzman pitched 6.1 scoreless innings without letting up a hit, with a K/BB ratio of 10:1. On 6/24, Guzman saw his first hiccup, walking 3 batters and letting up a hit to allow 2 earned runs. Guzman threw 50% strikes during his appearance and even had a pitch clock violation to make

his outing more difficult. Guzman walked three consecutive batters, including one with the bases loaded, before getting two groundouts and a strikeout. This outing shows the dangers of Guzman's high-effort pitching style with a tendency to lose the strike zone, but the previous 2 weeks also show the potential for Guzman to dominate hitters for extended periods of time.

### ***Development Path***

Although Guzman has not yet advanced past AAA in his career, if he continues to use his deceptive arm action and smart sequencing, he may succeed as a high-strikeout reliever that limits walks. Guzman pitched to a 2.95 ERA with a 3.28 xFIP in 2025 and even closed the Eastern League Championship for the Rumble Ponies in 2025, showing his ability to pitch in big moments and have continued success through a season. However, potential control issues and his age may limit his long-term impact at the highest levels. If Guzman can continue his extended stretches of limiting walks and striking out hitters, along with cleaning up his occasional blowup outings, he could be a bullpen arm who progresses to AAA once again and finally breaks into MLB for the Mets late in the year. Overall, Guzman's future projection remains uncertain, as it is unclear whether he will be able to establish a significant role at either the AAA or MLB levels.